

A PLEXEDGE GUIDE FOR BUYERS & INVESTORS

Buy a property that pays for itself.

Across Ontario you can now buy one property and run three, four, or five self-contained units on it — live in one and let tenants cover the mortgage with **as little as 5–10% down**, or hold it purely as an investment.

— THE OPPORTUNITY MOST BUYERS MISS

Most buyers are shopping for a single-family home and stretching to afford it. The smarter move: buy a property whose lot can legally hold multiple self-contained units, and let the rent do the heavy lifting. Since 2023 the zoning opened up across Ontario — and in 2024 the financing followed.

— HOW MANY UNITS YOU CAN RUN

3**ALMOST ANYWHERE**

Up to 3 self-contained units on nearly any Ontario lot — no special approval.

4**MANY CITIES**

Vaughan, Hamilton, Kitchener–Waterloo, London & more allow four.

5**IN TORONTO**

Four units in the main building plus a garden or laneway suite — five on one lot.

Not sure a property qualifies? Run PlexCheck free in 60 seconds → plexedge.ca/plexcheck

— THE FINANCING THAT MAKES IT WORK

If you'll live in one unit, CMHC treats a property with up to 4 units as your home — **as little as 5–10% down**, and half the tenants' rent counts toward qualifying you. Going bigger? At 5+ units you reach CMHC's commercial program (MLI Select) — longer amortization, higher leverage, and no requirement to live there. The building's income does the qualifying.

— TWO WAYS IN

HOUSE-HACK (LIVE-IN)

Your tenants carry the mortgage.

Buy a 2–4 unit property, live in one unit, rent the rest. Your tenants shrink — or erase — your monthly housing cost, and you're building equity from day one.

INVEST (INCOME)

Buy right, force the value up.

Acquire for cash flow, or add units to reach the 5-unit MLI Select threshold. Buy right, force the value up, and let it pay you while it appreciates.

WHAT IT CAN LOOK LIKE — AN ILLUSTRATION

A ~\$1.2M legal fourplex, owner-occupied. Down payment ≈ \$120,000 (10% — the minimum on a 3–4 unit purchase). You live in one unit; the three rented units bring roughly **\$6,000 / month**, and half of that rent counts toward qualifying you. The tenants carry most of the mortgage.

Illustrative only — not a quote, approval, or guarantee. Your actual numbers depend on the property, rents, interest rates and your income, and are confirmed by a CMHC-approved lender.

The catch — and how we help

Not every property works. It comes down to the city, the lot's width and depth, lane access, and permits — and most listings you'll scroll past won't qualify. We screen the market for the ones that fit this exact criteria, so you're looking at real candidates instead of guessing. Tell us your budget and goal, and we'll send you properties that actually pencil.

What it actually involves.

It's fewer moving parts than most people assume — because you're not doing it alone. Two cheap, early steps tell you if a deal is real before you spend on design or a build.

— THE PATH, START TO FINISH

01 · FREE Lot check PlexCheck shows what a property can legally hold — in about a minute.	02 · FEASIBILITY Does it pencil? A concept and rough all-in numbers. If it doesn't work, we tell you and stop.	03 · DESIGN The picture The unit mix, massing and a 3D of what the property becomes.	04 · APPROVALS Permit + money Full drawings to building permit; construction financing locked in.	05 · BUILD Lease or sell Our partner builds it; you lease the units, or sell the finished building.
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You get one point of contact across all five steps — the real-estate side and the construction side, coordinated. The two early steps are deliberately cheap so nobody spends real money on a deal that doesn't work.

— THE BENEFITS THAT MAKE THE MATH WORK

\$160K–270K DC WAIVER · TORONTO Toronto waives development charges on a multiplex's first six units — often a six-figure saving on a small build.	Full 13% HST RENTAL REBATE New purpose-built rental of four+ units can qualify to have the full HST rebated by federal and provincial programs.	Up to 50 yr CMHC AMORTIZATION Strong CMHC MLI Select design can unlock 40–50 year amortization plus premium discounts — lower payments, more cash flow.
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Want the full cost picture? Ask for our free **Multiplex Cost Assessment** — a plain-English breakdown of what a build actually runs (roughly \$250–350/sq ft before land and soft costs).

Programs, waivers, rates, and amounts are set by government and change; they apply to specific project types and unit counts and are confirmed at feasibility with the relevant professionals. Development-charge figures are Toronto-specific; other municipalities differ.

— FROM PLAN TO BUILT — ONE TEAM

Buying the lot is half of it. We bring the strategy, the research, and the salesperson side; our construction partner (15+ years, 200+ units) handles permits, the build, and a real quote. Most buyers don't know where to start — with PlexEdge you get both ends, from finding the property to turning it into units.

No guaranteed cost, timeline, or quote — every project is confirmed individually at feasibility.

WHO YOU'RE WORKING WITH

Taran Aujla

Taran comes at real estate from two sides. He's managed multi-unit rentals since his teens — raised around Montreal's plexes — and for close to a decade he practised business and real estate law in Ontario, closing several hundred transactions. Now a licensed Salesperson, he works document-first: read the file, build the position, understand both sides of the table. He also keeps a working list of buyers and investors he sends fitting properties to first — so the right lot can reach you before it hits the open market.

GET PROPERTIES THAT ACTUALLY FIT

Join the PlexEdge buyer list.

Off-market and value-add multiplex candidates, screened to this exact criteria — plus a free strategy call. Tell us your budget and goal, and we'll send you the ones that pencil.

Taran Aujla

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PlexEdge is a trade name of **Taran Aujla**, Salesperson · HomeLife G1 Realty Inc., Brokerage · Independently Owned & Operated · RECO Reg. No. 6024721 · plexedge.ca

Educational information only — not legal, planning, mortgage, tax, financial, or investment advice. Whether a specific property can hold three, four, or five units depends on the municipality's zoning, lot dimensions, lane access, permits and a site-specific review; mortgage eligibility, down payment and rental-income treatment are set by the lender and CMHC and confirmed by a CMHC-approved mortgage professional. Owner-occupied financing requires you to occupy one unit. Figures are illustrative and not a guarantee of financing, cost, income, or return. PlexEdge is not itself a brokerage, a developer building on its own account, or an investment vehicle. Not intended to solicit properties currently listed for sale or buyers already under a representation agreement with another brokerage.